

Skills intelligence and workforce optimisation

The 'skills-first' **model** of talent **acquisition** and management **is** the key to **thrive in** the evolving **landscape** for tech-driven enterprises

When times change, innovation and **revamping** operational procedures **comes across** as the best way to ensure **resilience** and maintain performance levels in an organisation. **Of late**, the dynamic changes in employment and **head-hunting**, and the rising emphasis on employee engagement, and **retention** has significantly changed workforce management. Today, **the key** to optimisation of the human resources available **lies** in understanding skills and skill **adjacencies**. Companies are **paying more attention to** internal relocation of resources and creating **precise** learning and skill development strategies to get better outcomes.

In this scenario, it is very clear that skills-based hiring processes are far more effective compared to the **conventional** job titles-driven recruitment. There is a **paradigm** shift that is based on identifying an individual's ability to perform, adapt to the demands of the role, and capacity for growth. There is much greater emphasis now on **soft skills** such as learning **agility** and **adaptability**. Technologies are changing rapidly, and change-resistance can be the biggest **detriment** to an individual's growth and capability of contributing to the organisation's growth as well. Therefore, it is important to **foster** a workforce that is ready to take up new roles and acquire skills that prepare them for those roles.

This kind of approach can be successful only when it is adequately **backed** by **transparent** internal **mobility** and recruitment focus. Companies that **put in place** tools and systems that **empower** employees to express their expectations, future growth aspirations and share opportunities with them that can take them closer to their goals, are also the ones that will perform better in the years ahead.

The **shift** to a Skills-First approach **is** directly **reflective** of the way the operational landscape has changed. One can no longer acquire skills that guarantee a lifetime of employment especially in the field of technology. Skills have become **fluid** and it is not uncommon to see them become **outdated** in a time frame shorter than what it takes to obtain a graduate degree or a PG diploma nowadays. Even though the job titles remain the same, the roles and the **execution** strategies are constantly changing. **For instance**, we still have computer programmers, but what a programmer does today is vastly different from what he did 15 years ago. There are also new roles that are emerging with the change in tech landscape, and they need to be **catered to**. For instance, nobody worked as a 'Full Stack Developer' at the start of the **millennium**, but today it is a key role in almost every tech organisation. Thus, it is important to understand that new skills are emerging and they are **necessitating** creation of new roles as well as redefining existing or conventional job titles.

This skills-driven strategy has led to most **prominent** employers starting their skill **assessment** journey for new hires, even before the start of the formal recruitment process. There are world-class, AI-powered skills intelligence tools to ensure there is no **inherent bias** in the process, no error or **inconsistency** of judgment and a focus on the skills that candidates possess instead of the job titles they hold. Organisations are using smart skills cloud and skills-driven hiring processes to continuously gain **insights** into their internal talent pool's skill assessment, and use this skills intelligence to determine learning programmes as well as the hiring strategies. All this is being done automatically without manual inputs from the employees.

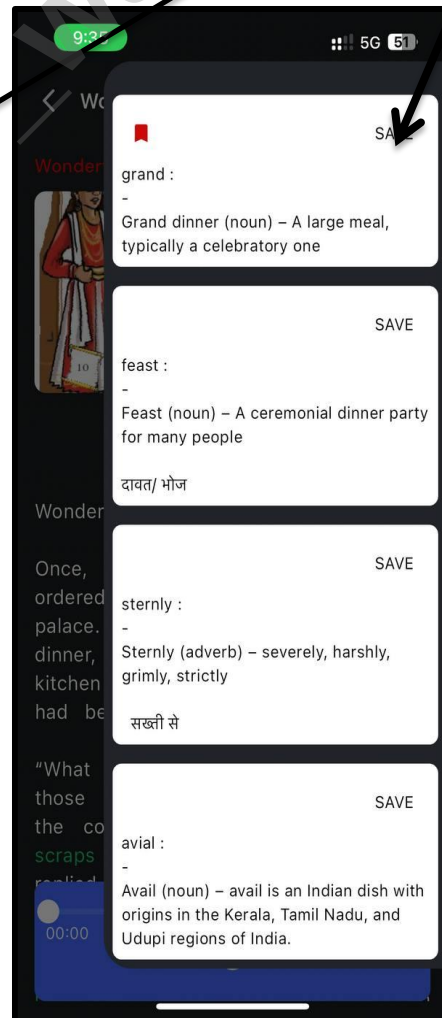
Companies that **proactively embrace** the new approach and adopt the right AI-powered skills intelligence tool **will edge out** those that continue to **rely on** traditional and time-consuming **methodologies**, and achieve superior growth as well as talent **retention** outcomes! [\[Practice Exercise\]](#)

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'

Vocabulary

1. **Optimisation** (noun) – Enhancement, Improvement, Maximization, Refinement, Streamlining सुधार
2. **Acquisition** (noun) – Procurement, Attainment, Obtaining, Securing, Gaining अधिग्रहण, प्रप्ति
3. **Thrive in** (phrasal verb) – Prosper, Flourish, Succeed, Excel, Blossom फलना-फूलना
4. **Landscape** (noun) – Terrain, Environment, Scenery, Setting, Backdrop परिदृश्य
5. **Revamp** (verb) – Overhaul, Renovate, Reform, Remodel, Redo सुधार करना
6. **Come across** (phrasal verb) – Encounter, Stumble upon, Discover, Find, Meet मिलना
7. **Resilience** (noun) – Toughness, Endurance, Fortitude, Robustness, Strength लचीलापन

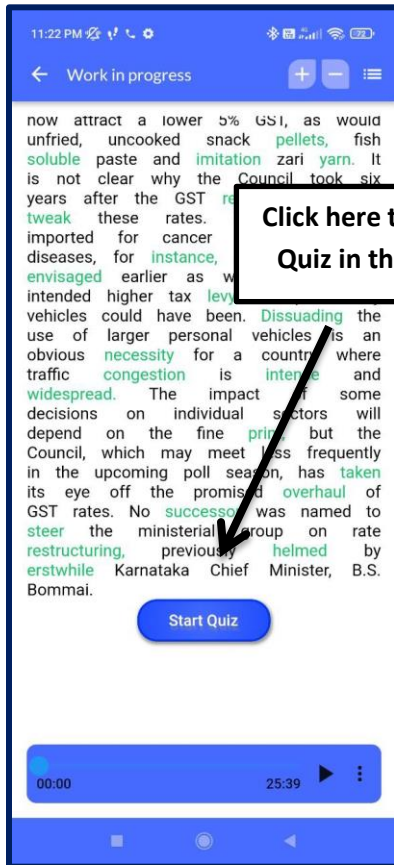
..... Remaining vocabs available on website and app vocab listing table as like mentioned in given below page.



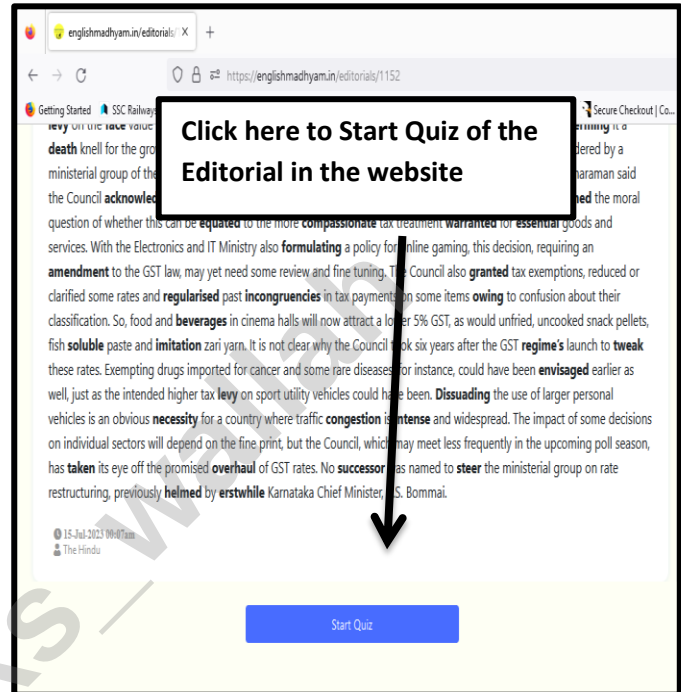
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Skills-First Model:** The editorial emphasizes the importance of a skills-first approach in talent acquisition and management, especially for tech-driven enterprises.
2. **Changing Times:** It highlights the need for innovation and revamping operational procedures in response to dynamic changes in employment and workforce management.
3. **Focus on Skills:** Understanding skills and skill adjacencies is crucial for optimizing human resources.
4. **Internal Relocation and Learning:** Companies are focusing more on internal resource relocation and creating specific learning and skill development strategies.
5. **Skills-Based Hiring:** Skills-based hiring processes are more effective than traditional job titles-driven recruitment.
6. **Emphasis on Soft Skills:** There's a greater emphasis on soft skills like learning agility and adaptability.
7. **Adaptability to Technological Changes:** The editorial stresses the importance of being adaptable to rapidly changing technologies.
8. **Transparent Internal Mobility:** Success in this approach requires transparent internal mobility and a recruitment focus that aligns with employees' growth aspirations.
9. **Operational Landscape Evolution:** The shift to a skills-first approach reflects changes in the operational landscape, especially in technology fields.
10. **Fluidity of Skills:** Skills are becoming fluid, with some becoming outdated quickly, necessitating continuous learning.
11. **Changing Roles and Strategies:** Job titles may remain the same, but the roles and execution strategies are constantly evolving.
12. **Emergence of New Roles:** New roles, like Full Stack Developers, have emerged due to changes in the tech landscape.
13. **Skill Assessment for New Hires:** Employers are beginning skill assessments for new hires even before the formal recruitment process using AI-powered tools.
14. **AI-Powered Skills Intelligence Tools:** These tools help in unbiased skill assessment and are used for internal talent pool skill assessments and determining learning programs and hiring strategies.
15. **Superior Growth and Talent Retention:** Companies adopting AI-powered skills intelligence tools and the new approach are likely to achieve better growth and talent retention outcomes.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



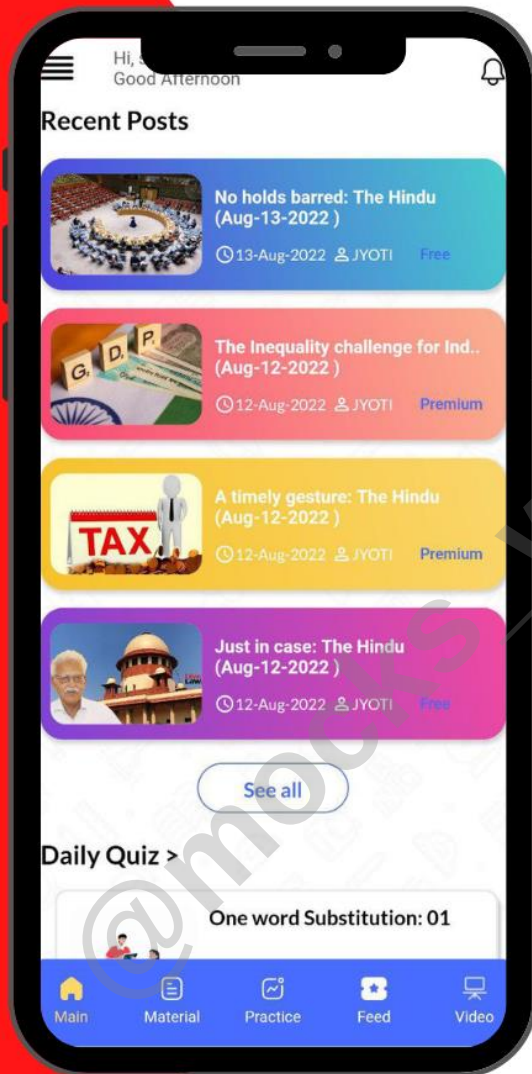
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